Activity : 2

Interview two senior citizens asking questions concerning there food beliefs, food preparations, changes in taste and smell, and the use of vitamin / minerals supplements.

4.2.2 Nutrition and food requirements of elderly.

These are based on the physiological changes that takes place during old age. The nutritional requirements change after the age of 40 years.

Energy.

Energy requirements declines with increasing age, particularly if physical activity is restricted.

After the age of 35 the basal metabolic rate decreases due to reduced muscle mass and other metabolically active tissue mass.

The calorie intake should be adjusted to maintain the body weight constant. In the case of obese, the calorie intake should be adjusted to reduce the body weight gradually to become normal level. Although the energy requirements decerease, the requirements for proteins ,vitamins and minerals do not diminish.

b) Carbohydrate

Emphasis is placed on increasing the consumption of complex carbohydrates and controlling the intake of simple sugars. Whole grain cereals and pulses should be included in the diet. It is necessary that at least 50 per cent of calories are derived from carbohydrates. Since caloric requirements are reduced, carbohydrates intake is also reduced.

DO YOU KNOW?

World Elders Day is on 1st October

c) Proteins

As people age, there is a decrease in skeletal tissue mass. This results in decrease in store of protein provided by skeletal muscle and may be inadequate to meet the needs of protein synthesis. Hence the dietary protein intake is more important to meet essential needs. A protein intake of 1g / kilogram body weight of a normal adult requirement, is safe during old age.

d) Fats

Elders who take sufficient omega 3 fatty acids have better visual acuity. Omega 3 fatty acids may help in conditions such as hair loss, impairment of vision, improper digestion and gas, poor kidney function, tissue inflammation, osteo-arthritis, painful joints and muscles and mental depression. Emphasis should be placed on reducing the intake of saturated fat and choosing monounsaturated or polyunsaturated fat sources.

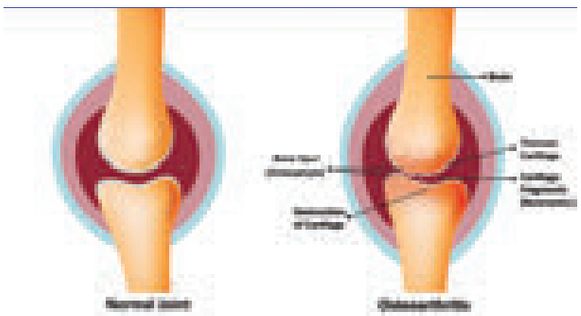


Fig 4.1 Wear and Tear Arthritis

e) Minerals

During old age calcium need increases. Women over 50 years of age who are not receiving oestrogens require more calcium to prevent demineralization of bone and osteoporosis. For women over fifty, 800 mg/ day is recommended. As caloric requirement decreases, total food consumption decreases, hence calcium supplement is essential.

Iron intake should be adequate to prevent anaemia. Iron requirement for men is 30mg. If there is anaemia, supplemental

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